Kevin Kim

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Education

University of California San Diego La Jolla, CA
Master of Science in Computer Science and Engineering *Sep. 2026 – June 2028*

Emory University Atlanta, GA
Bachelor of Science in Neuroscience, Minor in Computer Science *Aug. 2022 – May 2026*

- **Coursework:** Data Structures & Algorithms, Computer Systems/Architecture, Database Systems, Software Engineering, Data Mining, Linear Algebra, Probability & Statistics, Discrete Mathematics

Experience

Software Engineering Intern Aug. 2026 – Oct. 2026
Altasciences *Remote*

- Prototyping an LLM pipeline that turns clinical report templates and study source data into populated first drafts, targeting the highest-effort step in the report authoring workflow.
- Wiring LLM APIs to OCR ingestion over historical reports; building an evaluation harness measuring draft quality against author-edited ground truth.
- Interviewing report authors to scope the system and presenting a build/no-build recommendation to senior leadership.

Visiting Researcher – Human-Centered AI July 2026 – Dec. 2026
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign *Urbana, IL*

- Designed a randomized 2-week longitudinal field study (N=60) on LLM sycophancy, using a custom browser extension that silently injects opposing system instructions — mandated validation vs. mandated friction — into participants' own LLM sessions.
- Instrumented the extension to log and classify prompt structure over 14 days, testing whether sustained flattery measurably degrades user auditing behavior and downstream reasoning accuracy on a trap-laden exit task.
- Authored a comparative review of five recent sycophancy papers, identifying survivorship bias in Reddit-sampled cohorts and the failure of cosine-similarity keyword filters to detect implicit sycophancy.
- Presenting and critiquing papers in a weekly seminar reading group; collaborating with peers on shared research directions.

Research Assistant – Multi-Agent Systems May 2026 – Present
Emory University, advised by Dr. Kai Shu *Atlanta, GA*

- Exploring novel multi-agent topologies aimed at giving LLM systems metacognitive capability, with the goal of improving performance on reasoning and cognitive task suites.
- Implementing orchestration, inter-agent communication, and tool-calling interfaces in Python; comparing topology variants against single-agent baselines.
- Extending evaluation to clinical agent benchmarks including MedAgentBench.
- Writing literature reviews on multi-agent architectures and machine metacognition to situate the work against existing approaches.

Artificial Intelligence Research Fellow Jan. 2025 – May 2026
Emory Center for AI Learning *Atlanta, GA*

- Built an NLP pipeline (DistilBERT + Rasch IRT) over 2000 student assessment and free-text feedback records to evaluate Emory's Chemistry Unbound curriculum, replacing a manual review process taking 50+ hours per cycle.
- Engineered a stacked-ensemble model (XGBoost, MLP, and CNN base learners under an XGBoost meta-learner) over custom spatiotemporal features to predict explosive NFL run plays, reaching 0.71 AUC, outperforming other contemporary models.
- Engineered a Bayesian State-space model that reliably predicts NFL kicker outcomes based on latent kicker talent values to help build a proper kicker elo system.

Health Economics Research Assistant Sep. 2022 – May 2026
Emory University *Atlanta, GA*

- Built econometric models in R over national MEPS and AHRF datasets (30K+ records of individuals from surveys) to quantify disparities in mental health access and provider reimbursement; compiled a nationwide mental health parity law database.

Teaching Experience

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant, DATASCI 497R Jan. 2026 – May 2026
Emory Center for AI Learning *Atlanta, GA*

- Mentored 30+ undergraduate researchers through the full arc of their projects, from scoping a question to presenting results.
- Designed and delivered lessons and workshops on Python, PyTorch, and ML tooling for students new to the stack.
- Partnered with external project sponsors including Invest Atlanta and the Nell Hodgson Woodruff School of Nursing to translate their questions into tractable, data-backed analyses.

Projects

Music Social Platform | *React Native, Expo, PostgreSQL, Python, Vercel* Dec. 2025 – Apr. 2026

- Shipped a cross-platform (Android + web) social app for playlist creation and taste-based discovery, backed by a 1M-track catalog curated from open-source MusicBrainz data.
- Cut search latency from 35 ms to 12 ms by moving to PostgreSQL full-text search with GIN-indexed tsvector columns.
- Trained a Random Forest recommender on the Spotify Million Playlist Dataset with cross-validated tuning; extending to a stacked ensemble with two-tower retrieval and spectrogram features.

Virtual Pet Simulator – Web & Raspberry Pi | *React, JavaScript, Python, Supabase* April. 2026 – Present

- Built a full-stack app for interacting with and sharing virtual pets: React frontend, Vercel-hosted backend, Supabase persistence, sprite-sheet animation on HTML5 canvas.
- Porting to a Raspberry Pi + E-ink build for a self-hosted hardware version; added a regression model predicting pet stat decay over time and actions.

Publications & Presentations

Perceptions and Needs for a Technology-Based Dyadic Intervention on Symptom Management Among Patients With Colorectal Cancer and Their Caregivers — Epari, A., **Kim, K.**, Xiao, C., et al. *Cancer Nursing* (2024). DOI: 10.1097/NCC.0000000000001429

Boom! Using Explosive Plays to Predict the Next Breakout Running Back — *Emory Center for AI Learning Research Showcase*, 2025. **Best Poster Award.**

A Multi-Modal Evaluation of Chemistry Unbound using IRT and Sentiment Analysis — *Emory Center for AI Learning Research Showcase*, 2025.

Regional Variation in the Acceptance of Insurance by Mental Health Professionals: Evidence from MEPS — *Southern Regional Science Association Conference*, 2024.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, Java, C, C++, JavaScript/TypeScript, SQL, R, Swift, HTML/CSS
Frameworks & Libraries: PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, pandas, NumPy, React, React Native, Node.js, Expo, Prisma, JUnit
Infrastructure & Tools: Git, Docker, Kubernetes, AWS, Linux, GitHub Actions, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Supabase, Firebase, Vercel, ChromaDB, LangFuse, MCP